Policy ID: POL-002
Title: Case Follow-Up and Status Update Policy
Version: 1.0 | Effective date: 1 January 2026 | Owner: Ethics Office

SYNTHETIC DOCUMENT - fictional guidance created for a technical prototype. It does not describe any real organisation's policy.

Case Follow-Up and Status Update Policy

1. Purpose

This policy explains how to follow up on a concern you have already submitted, how to add information to it, and when a new request is or is not appropriate.

2. Case reference numbers

Every concern receives a case reference number in the format CR-YYYY-NNNNN (for example, CR-2026-00417). It is sent in the acknowledgement message. Anonymous reporters also receive an anonymous access key (see POL-005).

3. Standard timelines

The Ethics Office aims to: acknowledge a concern within 5 business days of submission; complete an initial assessment within 15 business days of submission; and provide a status update at least every 30 calendar days while the case remains open.

Complex cases may take longer. If a timeline will be missed, the Ethics Office should inform the reporter.

4. How to request an update

Use the Check Case Status option on the Integrity Portal, or reply to your acknowledgement message.

Quote your case reference number. If you do not have it, give the approximate date or period when you submitted the concern and the channel you used (portal, helpline, email or line manager), so the Ethics Office can locate the case.

5. Adding information to an existing case

If you have new facts, documents or witness details about a concern you already reported, add them to the existing case using the same reference number. Do not open a new case for them.

6. Should I submit a new request?

Do not submit a new request for a concern that has already been submitted. Duplicate submissions split the information across cases and slow down the review.

Follow up on the existing case instead, even if you have not yet received an update.

Submit a new request only when: (a) the matter is a different concern from the one already reported; or (b) you received no acknowledgement within 5 business days and the Ethics Office confirms it has no record of your original submission.

7. Escalating a delayed case

If a standard timeline in section 3 has passed without an update, you may ask for the case to be escalated to the Ethics Office Case Review Lead. Quote the case reference number or approximate submission date in the escalation request.

8. What a status update contains

Updates confirm the stage the case has reached (for example: received, under assessment, under investigation, closed). Details about other individuals or disciplinary outcomes may be withheld to protect confidentiality under POL-005.